



CSU MBA Marketing Management

Course Information

Dr. Kelly Martin, she/her

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Office hours: by appointment

In-person Meeting: Tuesdays, 5:30–9:10 p.m. Mountain Time; Rockwell West 118

2026 Course Dates: Eight-week session beginning August 24 and concluding October 17

IC Team: Rod Thirion, Lead (Rodney.Thirion@colostate.edu), Jenn Stickel

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Course Description

Marketing Management provides a broad overview of all the marketing activities involved in the provision of products and services to end consumers and organizational customers. More specifically, this course: (1) provides students with an understanding of marketing concepts; (2) applies learned marketing concepts to real world situations; and (3) examines the modification of marketing strategy within a changing global environment.

Learning Objectives

By the completion of this course participants should be able to:

1. Demonstrate mastery of marketing terminology and concepts.
2. Understand the perspectives and influences that shape marketing decision making.
3. Connect marketing functions to organizational goals of customer value creation.

Prerequisites

No prior marketing knowledge is required.

Required Materials

All course materials will be accessed through Harvard Business Publishing, where I have created a Coursepack specifically for our class (the link to our Harvard Business Coursepack is [here](#) and on Canvas: <https://hbsp.harvard.edu/import/1414661>). All readings, cases, and the simulation will be used in class and must be purchased.

Class Organization and Activities

Students will read text, participate in class discussions, and apply course knowledge to real-world marketing scenarios. Students will engage in discussion in each session and learn from guest speakers where appropriate. Case studies and marketing simulations may be utilized to help students understand the complexity of navigating marketing decisions.

- **In-class lecture:** This course is viewed as live classroom capture either in real time, or at the student's convenience during the week. Live classes are recorded on Tuesday evenings from 5:30–9:10 Mountain Time. Video production will have the recorded classes posted by noon the following day, barring technical difficulties. Class sessions are designed to spark conversation and to further enhance the concepts about which you are learning in your course readings. Thus, it is critical you read prior to coming to class or watching the video. Mastery of the concepts happens through good preparation.
- **Guest experts:** Our learning also will be enhanced by various guest experts that will visit our class either in-person or virtually. Learning will come from concept application and dialogue with these guests. The more students prepare the day's readings, the better our discussion with guests will be. The quality of our learning depends on everyone being well-prepared and actively engaged in meaningful discussion in with these special guests.
- **Class discussion:** It is important to me to hear from all students in the class. To promote engagement with both online students and in-class students, we will use our Canvas Discussion platform to share experiences and insights related to marketing and the various topics we will cover. Each week, I will pose a prompt or question. Every student is expected to engage in the conversation by sharing at least one original post and at least two replies to other students. Sometimes we will revisit these conversations during the live class sessions as well. See below and on Canvas for further details.
- **Canvas:** Canvas will be used as a place for me to make announcements, for us to share information, and for you to access your readings, complete quizzes and assignments, respond to discussion prompts, and take your exams. I expect all students to monitor Canvas often for information and potential announcements.

Grades

Learning Activity	Points Possible
Readings Quizzes (8 @ 20 points each)	160
Weekly Discussions (8 @ 20 points each)	160
Simulation Reflection (6 decisions @ 20 points each)	120
Simulation Performance (automatically assessed)	100
Final Exam	<u>200</u>
Total:	740

Grading Breakdown

Percentage	Point Total	Letter Grade
90-100%	666-740	A
80-89.99%	592-665	B
70-79.99%	518-591	C
60-69.99%	444-517	D
Below 60%	443 & below	F

Course Preparation

In lieu of a textbook, this course features readings from Harvard Business School's *Core Marketing Series*. All readings must be purchased and completed prior to class time or watching the lecture. Students in past classes have enjoyed these readings, and they remain a great way to understand the field of marketing through a business professional's lens. Each week's reading should take students approximately 2 hours, with additional time for quizzes, discussion posts, and the simulation. CSU and the College of Business expect 2-3 hours of outside coursework per each credit hour. As a 2-credit class, the reading and outside preparation time should be quite commensurate with courses across the MBA program. Students are responsible for all content. Any lecture or reading content is fair game in quizzes and exams.

Quizzes

Weekly quizzes are made available immediately following the lecture and must be completed by 11:59 p.m. the Sunday before the next class period. Quizzes are open book/open notes and need to be finished within 50 minutes of opening the quiz. Each quiz contains 10 questions and is worth 20 points total. Note, quiz questions may come from the readings, the lecture, or guest expert content. If you would like to work on the quizzes with a classmate, this is acceptable and encouraged. You must each complete and submit your own quiz, however. As with exams, please contact your IC if you will be late. Late work is subject to a loss in points—20% of the score per day late, however, quizzes can only be completed up to the start of the next week's class.

Weekly Discussions

Weekly discussion prompts also are made available immediately following the lecture and must be completed by 11:59 p.m. the Sunday before the next class period. Discussions are meant to be a low-pressure way to converse with your classmates. Each student will complete a discussion post via Canvas in the Discussion section. Please feel free to use any materials, but I am most interested in your own thoughts and experiences relevant to the course topics. To receive credit, you must create 1) an original post with your own responses to the question/prompt and then 2) provide at least two replies to any of your classmates' posts. Grading is based on the quality of your engagement (see Canvas for details). Late

posts will result in a loss of points, including a deduction of 20% from the total score per day late. Your ICs will not view weekly discussions beyond the start of the next in-class session.

Simulation

In addition to the weekly quizzes and discussions, we will complete a marketing simulation activity in this class. The simulation runs over six weeks beginning in Week 2. You gain access to this simulation when you purchase our Harvard Business Coursepack. Simulations are a great way to gain hands-on experience making marketing decisions. They are also interactive and fun. We will talk through the logistics of the simulation, as well as learnings and takeaways, throughout the session.

Grading occurs two ways. First, after each decision period, you will provide a brief reflection or evaluation of how you made your decisions (around a paragraph but no more than 1 page). Each reflection is worth 20 points (completed for each of six decision periods) and will be graded on the quality of your assessment, for 120 points total (see Canvas for the grading rubric). Second, you will be graded automatically through the simulation software based on how well your “company” does across the six periods. This assessment comprises another 100 points and is determined by the performance indicators described in the simulation software and in the student information provided by Marketplace Simulations. Decisions cannot be completed late, and all six decisions must be made to receive credit. Simulation reflection assignments submitted late will receive a score reduced by 20% per day late. As with other assignments, simulation reflections will not be accepted beyond the start of the next class session.

Exams

This class features a comprehensive final exam. The format and structure of the exam will be explained in class in advance. Exams cannot be taken late. If you know you will be traveling, please contact your IC to schedule a time outside of our class exam window.

Participation and Professionalism

Regular and timely participation is expected and necessary for successful completion of this course. In addition, it is expected that all communications with your instructor, ICs, or guest experts are conducted in a professional and courteous manner. Course success is directly related to reading and preparation, watching lectures/regular class attendance, and mutual professionalism.

Course Schedule

Week	Meeting Date	Topic/Session	Preparation/Deliverable (All deadlines in Mountain Time, Denver, CO USA)
1	8-25	Course Overview and Introductions - Course learning objectives - Assignments and structure - Student introductions Marketing's Role in Organizations - Introduction to the marketing strategy framework - Creating customer value	Module 1 Readings: 1) Marketing Strategy Framework; AND 2) Creating Customer Value Module 1 Quiz + Discussion Due by Sunday, August 30, 11:59 p.m.
2	9-1	Understanding our Place in the Market - Segmentation, targeting, and positioning - Competitive positioning and differentiation	Module 2 Reading: Segmentation and Targeting Module 2 Quiz + Discussion Due Module 2 Simulation (Q1 Decision) Assignment Due by Sunday, September 6, 11:59 p.m.
3	9-8	Understanding our Customers - The psychology of marketing - Consumer buying process - Business customer purchasing processes	Module 3 Reading: 1) Consumer Behavior and the Buying Process; AND 2) Business-to-Business Marketing Module 3 Quiz + Discussion Due Module 3 Simulation (Q2 Decision) Assignment Due by Sunday, September 13, 11:59 p.m.
4	9-15	Marketing Intelligence - Intro to marketing intelligence - How intelligence informs the marketing strategy framework - Research methods overview - Customer data and AI in marketing decision making	Module 4 Reading: Marketing Intelligence Module 4 Quiz + Discussion Due Module 4 Simulation (Q3 Decision) Assignment Due by Sunday, September 20, 11:59 p.m.
5	9-22	Products, Services, and Brands Product types and strategies	Module 5 Reading: 1) Product Policy; AND 2) Revisit Creating

		- Product life cycle and new product development - Marketing services - Brands and brand equity	Customer Value Reading pages 28–30 Module 5 Quiz + Discussion Due Module 5 Simulation (Q4 Decision) Assignment Due by Sunday, September 27, 11:59 p.m.
6	9–29	Marketing Communications - Communication types - Using the 6M Model	Module 6 Reading: Marketing Communications Module 6 Quiz + Discussion Due Module 6 Simulation (Q5 Decision) Assignment Due by Sunday, October 4, 11:59 p.m.
7	10–6	Pricing and Distribution - Distribution channels - Innovatively reaching customers - Pricing strategies	Module 7 Reading: 1) Channels of Distribution; AND 2) Pricing Strategy Module 7 Quiz + Discussion Due Module 7 Simulation (Q6 Decision) Assignment Due by Sunday, October 11, 11:59 p.m.
8	10–13	Marketing Globally - Global consumer culture - Firm approaches to marketing worldwide Final Exam Review - Review topics of your choosing Course Wrap-up	Module 8 Reading: Global Marketing Module 8 Quiz + Discussion Due and Final Exam Due by Saturday, October 17, 11:59 p.m. *Please note the Saturday due date for all Week 8 items.

Learning Accommodation

The College of Business and CSU is committed to the principles of universal learning. This means that our classroom, our virtual spaces, our practices, and our interactions should be as inclusive as possible. Mutual respect, civility, and the ability to listen and observe others carefully are crucial to universal learning. If you are a student who will need accommodations in this class, please contact me to discuss your individual needs. Any accommodations must be discussed in a timely manner. A verifying memo from The Student Disability Center (SDC)

may be required before any accommodation is provided. For more information connect here, via this [link](#) that takes you to the Institute for Teaching and Learning, or use the QR code:



Academic Integrity

Students are expected to behave in a manner consistent with an upper-division business course. If classroom or online behavior does not meet this expectation, the student's final participation and professionalism grade will be reduced accordingly. In addition, all students are expected to follow University policies with respect to academic dishonesty such as cheating, plagiarism, or knowingly furnishing false information to the University. This instructor will adhere to the Academic Integrity Policy of the General Catalog and the Student Professional Conduct Code.

Plagiarism

Colorado State University subscribes to Turnitin, a web-based plagiarism detection/prevention service. Papers submitted to Turnitin are compared to resources in the database. The results of the comparison (including hyperlinks to web pages or other papers with the same text) are then sent to the instructor. Students agree that by taking a course, all required papers, exams, class projects or other assignments submitted for credit may be submitted to turnitin.com or similar third parties to review and evaluate for originality and intellectual integrity. A description of the services, terms and conditions of use, and privacy policy of turnitin.com is available on its website: <http://www.turnitin.com>. Understand that all work submitted to turnitin.com will be added to its database of papers. Further understand that if the results of such a review support an allegation of academic dishonesty, the course work in question as well as any supporting materials may be submitted to the Student Resolution Center at CSU for investigation and further action.

Policy on Generative AI

At CSU's College of Business, we recognize that generative AI is a powerful tool that can enhance productivity, creativity, and problem-solving, unlocking innovation across various business domains. However, AI also has its limitations, including the potential to produce inaccurate, biased, and misleading information. Overreliance on AI can also diminish critical thinking skills if not balanced with human insight, expertise, and judgement. Our goal is to teach you how to use emerging AI tools responsibly. This requires developing your critical thinking and domain expertise to effectively evaluate AI-generated content, a skill increasingly valuable in an AI-dominated world. This balanced approach allows you to

leverage AI's benefits while also building the competencies needed to critically assess its output, identify its limitations, and innovate beyond its capabilities. Therefore, depending on the course and its specific learning objectives, AI use may be encouraged, restricted, or even prohibited. These different approaches across classes are intentional and designed to provide you with a well-rounded education that prepares you for the complexities of the modern business world.

In this course, generative AI is allowed except for during exams. If you use generative AI on in-class assignments or cases, however, you must disclose (if in a discussion format) or cite (if in a written format) your use of it. Note that you are responsible for the content of the generated content and its accuracy. AI can be unreliable and sometimes hallucinates. Failure to comply with this policy will be regarded as a breach of the CSU Academic Integrity Policy and Student Conduct Code.

For more information about practicing academic integrity at CSU, visit <https://tilt.colostate.edu/integrity/studentresources/>.

Student Professional Code of Conduct, Department of Marketing

The Department of Marketing has created this Student Code of Conduct to support a productive and stimulating learning environment in all marketing classes. The code is designed to help ensure a positive atmosphere for the vast majority of students who currently exhibit the professional standards detailed below.

Students should exhibit professional classroom values and behavior by:

- Engaging in appropriate communication and interaction.
- Demonstrating trust, respect and civilities.
- Approaching course content as important and necessary for success in business.
- Engaging in responsible classroom activities such as:
 - turning off cell phones
 - not using electronic devices to send or receive messages during class
 - avoiding unnecessary talking
 - not reading outside material or doing other work during class

Students should contribute to a positive learning environment by:

- Arriving, attending, and departing class in a professional manner.
- Taking responsibility for team and individual assignments.
- Developing cooperative relationships with other students and faculty.

Students should support a professional environment within the College of Business by:

- Avoiding inappropriate language in and near classrooms and offices.
- Refraining from unrealistic expectations in dealing with administration, faculty, and staff.

Students must uphold the academic integrity standards as explained in the university's 2026–2027 General Catalog (www.catalog.colostate.edu) Section 1.6. Academic integrity is

conceptualized as doing and taking credit for one's own work. Violations of the university's academic integrity standards include, but are not limited to:

- Cheating in the classroom. "Cheating includes using unauthorized sources of information and providing or receiving unauthorized assistance on any form of academic work."
- Plagiarism. "Plagiarism includes the copying of language, structure, ideas, or thoughts of another, and representing them as one's own without proper acknowledgment."
- Unauthorized Possession or Disposition of Academic Materials. "Unauthorized possession or disposition of academic materials includes the unauthorized selling or purchasing of examinations or other academic work; stealing another student's work; unauthorized entry to or use of material in a computer file; theft or mutilation of library materials; and using information from or possessing exams that an instructor did not authorize for release to students."
- Falsification. "Falsification encompasses any untruth, either verbal or written, in one's academic work."
- Facilitation of Cases of Academic Dishonesty. "Facilitation of any act of academic dishonesty including cheating, plagiarism, and/or falsification of documents also constitutes violation of Colorado State University's academic integrity."

Violations of Colorado State University's academic integrity policies will be handled in accordance with the procedures discussed in the 2026-2027 General Catalog.

Please note that faculty members and administrative professionals at CSU must also abide by a Code of Ethical Behavior. This code is included on the CSU website (<http://facultycouncil.colostate.edu/files/manual/sectiond.htm#D.9>) and states among other things that faculty members are expected to "maintain a high level of discretion and respect in personal and professional relations with students, staff, and the public." This code also notes that faculty must eschew academic misconduct such as fabrication, falsification, and plagiarism.